

SPEAKING A2 – TOPIC 8: *FAVORITE PICTURE*

PART 1: INTERVIEW

1. What's your name? Can I see your ID?
2. Where are you from?
3. Are you drawing or painting pictures now?
4. When was the last time you went to an art gallery or exhibition?
5. What kind of pictures do you like having in your home?

PART 2: LONG TURN

Describe a picture (painting or photograph) you like

You should say:

- *What the picture is*
- *When you first saw it*
- *What it shows or depicts*

and explain why you like this picture

You will have to talk about the topic for 2 to 3 minutes. You have one minute to think about what you're going to say. You can make some notes to help you if you wish.

PART 3: TWO-WAY DISCUSSION

1. Do you think animals can be creative?
2. Should we use animals in performance?
3. Should we keep animals in the zoo?
4. Should art be taught in all schools?

SUGGESTIONS

PART 1: INTERVIEW

⇒ *Suggested answers:*

3. Are you drawing or painting pictures now?

I'm not drawing or painting pictures at the moment, but I used to do it when I was younger. I sometimes take photos instead because it's faster and still helps me express creativity.

4. When was the last time you went to an art gallery or exhibition?

- *I went to an art gallery last summer when I was traveling with my friends. We saw many beautiful paintings by local artists, and it was a relaxing and inspiring experience.*
- *I have never gone to an art gallery before. I usually see paintings or photos online instead, but I hope I can visit a real exhibition one day because it must be more impressive in person.*
- *I scarcely remember the last time I went to an art gallery. Maybe it was when I was a child on a school trip. It's been a long time, so I'd like to go again to enjoy the atmosphere and learn something new.*

5. What kind of pictures do you like having in your home?

I like having pictures of nature and family photos in my home. They make the rooms feel peaceful and remind me of good memories with the people I love.

PART 2: LONG TURN

1. Selection

This can be a difficult topic if you select the wrong photo. An easy option is a holiday photo – then you can describe some aspects of the holiday.

2. Grammar Point

Use mostly past tenses:

- *I took the photo whilst on holiday 3 years ago.*
- *While I was on that holiday I spent a lot of time travelling.*
- *The thing that I remember most about the holiday was when I*
- *I've hung the photo on my wall.*

3. Uncommon Vocabulary

Nouns	Meaning	Example
snapshot	ảnh chụp vội	<i>I took a snapshot of my family at the beach, and it brings back lovely memories.</i>
landscape shot	ảnh phong cảnh	<i>The landscape shot of rice fields reminds me of my trip to the countryside last year.</i>
studio print	ảnh in chuyên nghiệp	<i>I bought a studio print of a famous painting after visiting an art gallery.</i>
frame	khung ảnh	<i>I put the picture in a wooden frame and hung it above my desk.</i>
memory	ký ức	<i>This photo brings back happy memories of my school graduation day.</i>

Verbs	Meaning	Example
capture	ghi lại, bắt được khoảnh khắc	<i>This photograph captures the exact moment when the sun set behind the mountains.</i>
develop	tráng ảnh, rửa ảnh	<i>My father used to develop photos from film when I was a child.</i>
pose (for the camera)	tạo dáng trước ống kính	<i>We all posed for the camera during our family reunion.</i>
zoom in on	phóng to, tập trung vào	<i>The photographer zoomed in on the child's smiling face, which made the photo more touching.</i>
touch up	chỉnh sửa nhẹ (ảnh hoặc tranh)	<i>I touched up the picture a little to make the colors look brighter and clearer.</i>

Adjectives	Meaning	Example
photogenic	ăn ảnh	<i>My best friend looks very photogenic in this picture taken at our graduation.</i>
picturesque	đẹp như tranh vẽ	<i>The painting shows a picturesque view of a small village surrounded by mountains.</i>
camera-friendly	lên hình đẹp, dễ chụp ảnh	<i>The soft light made the whole scene very camera-friendly.</i>
memorable	đáng nhớ	<i>That photo is memorable because it was taken on my first trip abroad.</i>
vivid	sinh động, rực rỡ	<i>The painting is full of vivid colors that make it come alive.</i>

Idioms	Meaning	Example
do justice to (something)	thể hiện đúng, diễn tả được hết vẻ đẹp của...	<i>The photo doesn't do justice to the real view — it was even more beautiful in person.</i>
strike a pose	tạo dáng chụp ảnh	<i>My sister struck a cute pose when we took the picture at the park.</i>
bring back memories	gợi lại kỷ niệm	<i>This old photo brings back memories of my childhood days with my grandparents.</i>
be fond of	thích, yêu mến	<i>I'm very fond of this painting because it was a gift from my best friend.</i>
touch up a photo	chỉnh sửa lại ảnh cho đẹp hơn	<i>She touched up the photo before printing it and putting it in a frame.</i>

PART 3: TWO-WAY DISCUSSION

⇒ *Suggested answers*

1. Do you think animals can be creative?

(Answer) *I think animals can be creative in their own way.*

(Why) *Some animals, like dolphins or chimpanzees, can use tools or even paint with their trainers, which shows imagination and learning.*

(Example) *For instance, I once saw a video of an elephant painting flowers with its trunk, and it looked quite artistic.*

(Opposite) *On the other hand, some people argue that animals only follow training, so it might not really be creativity like humans have.*

2. Should we use animals in performances?

(Answer) *I don't think animals should be used in performances.*

(Why) *Many shows make animals perform unnatural acts, which can cause them stress or harm.*

(Example) *For example, circus animals often live in small cages and are forced to do tricks just to entertain people.*

(Opposite) *However, I can see that some performances aim to raise awareness about wildlife protection. As long as animals are treated well and the purpose is educational, this idea should also be taken into consideration.*

3. Should we keep animals in zoos?

(Answer) *I think we can keep some animals in zoos, but only under good conditions.*

(Why) *Zoos can help protect endangered species and teach people about the importance of conservation.*

(Example) *For instance, many modern zoos have natural habitats where animals can move freely and live safely.*

(Opposite) *Still, I understand the concern that wild animals may lose their natural instincts. This perspective should be respected, as it reminds us to balance education with animal welfare.*

4. Should art be taught in all schools?

(Answer) *Yes, I believe art should be included in every school's curriculum.*

(Why) *Art encourages creativity, emotional development, and critical thinking, which are important for students' growth.*

(Example) *For example, painting or photography lessons can help students relax and express their ideas more freely.*

(Opposite) *On the other hand, I agree that some schools may struggle with time and resources. This challenge should be acknowledged so we can find balanced solutions, such as offering art as an optional subject.*